Rightsizing Engagement Recap: What We Heard
October 29 - November 2, 2026

Executive Summary

This memo is a summary of public feedback on the proposed rightsizing scenarios. It covers community input gathered between **October 29th and October November 2nd, 2026**.

Between October 29th and October November 2nd, PPS hosted the following engagement sessions:

- Educator Town Hall (October 29th)

As of November 2nd, we have received 3,408 responses from parents/guardians, PPS staff, students, and community members representing all of our school communities. About 93% of respondents represented school communities affected by the rightsizing scenario proposals in some way, including school closure, school consolidation, program changes, or boundary changes.

In this What We Heard memo, we present survey data collected to date, a summary of the educator town hall meeting, and a deep dive into feedback about transitional supports discussed by community members.

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Introduction

Every Monday, from when the rightsizing plans were released on October 5th until Superintendent Armstrong gives her recommendation to the board, the Data and Accountability team will gather and summarize public feedback. The purpose of these reports is to be open and clear. We want to share what community members have told us and explain how we will use that information. This memo shares what we have heard from our community between October 28 - November 2, 2026.

Scenario Feedback Survey Findings to Date

As of November 2nd, we have received 3,408 responses from parents/guardians, PPS staff, students, and community members representing all of our school communities! Responses have been collected in English, Simplified Chinese, Spanish, Vietnamese, and Russian. The survey is available in Somali, but no Somali-language responses have been collected. About 93% of respondents represented school communities affected by the rightsizing scenario proposals in some way, including school closure, school consolidation, program changes, or boundary changes. See Tables 1-3 for a breakdown of respondent demographics, and see Appendix A for counts of responses by school to date.

Table 1:
Percentage of Respondents Representing Community Roles

Community Group	# of Respondents	% Of Respondents
Parent/Guardian	2856	74%
Student	181	5%
Staff/Educator	325	8%
Community Member	492	13%

Table 2:
Percentage of Respondents with Students Receiving Services

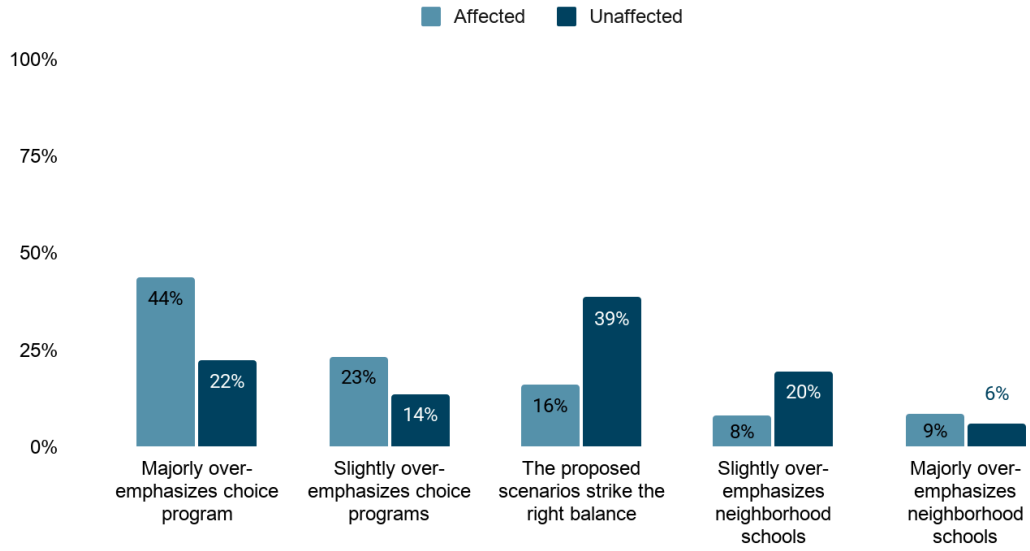
Services Received	# of Respondents	% Of Respondents
Special Education	675	21%
Multilingual Learner Services	51	2%
Dual Language Immersion	478	15%
Talented and Gifted	725	22%
None of the above/Prefer not to say	1354	41%

Table 3:
Percentage of Respondents by Race/Ethnicity

Race/Ethnicity of Respondents	# of Respondents	% Of Respondents
Asian	184	5%
Black/African American	93	3%
Latino/a/e	263	7%
American Indian/Alaskan Native	50	1%
Native Hawaiian/Pacific Islander	14	>1%
White	2284	63%
Multi-Racial	252	7%
Prefer Not to Say	458	13%

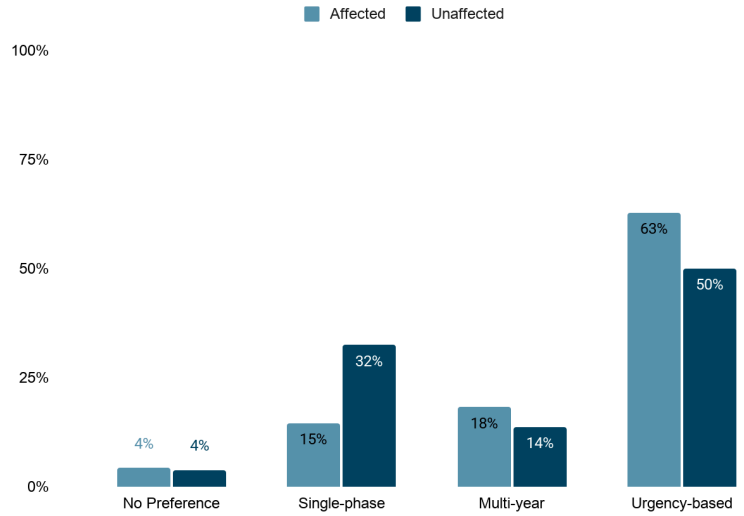
Survey Response Analysis
Below, we present the results for close-ended questions regarding rightsizing preferences, disaggregated by whether or not a respondent is directly affected by the proposed scenarios or not. Affected schools include any building facing a closure, a boundary change, or a programming change.

Resolution 7307 says that neighborhood schools are the foundation of the system when balancing access to choice programs. How well do the proposed scenarios balance those two needs? (n = 2605)



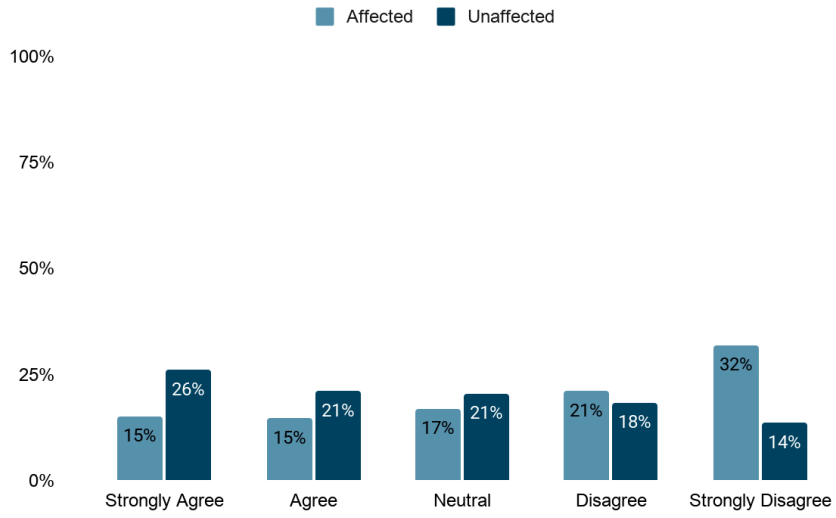
Taken together, over half of affected respondents think that the proposed scenarios over-emphasize programs of choice.

Rightsizing involves a trade-off between how large changes are and how often they occur. Which approach best aligns with your priorities? (n = 2940)



The majority of both affected and unaffected respondents urge the district to use an urgency-based approach to sequence rightsizing implementation decisions.

How much do you agree with this statement? "I am willing to accept a larger near-term adjustment (e.g., boundary change or closure) if it guarantees my school will not face further rightsizing for at least 5 years." (n = 2991)



There is no clear preference for whether respondents would prefer a larger near-term boundary change to prevent further rightsizing in Portland Public Schools.

Open-Ended Response Analysis

The survey asked the following open-ended questions:

- What specific support (e.g., transportation to school, students staying with their classmates) would you need if school changes occur all at once instead of over several years?
- What specific resources or help should the district provide to support schools affected by rightsizing?
- Our goal is to create a model that is fair and equitable to all communities. Did we miss any important equity issues, community history, or student needs in creating these models? If yes, please tell us what we missed and how we can address it.
- What is one thing you would like us to know about your school community?

Below, we present emerging findings from all open-ended questions centering one key theme: supports that students and staff affected by rightsizing will need as part of their transition. These themes are first presented broadly, and then they are disaggregated by stakeholder groups.

District-Wide Support Requests

Over half of all respondents (52.7%) state that transportation support is the most important. Families who are currently walking or biking to their neighborhood school expressed concern over walkable routes and facing longer commutes across busy streets. Parents shared that district-provided yellow busing, expanded crossing guard coverage, safe street crossing infrastructure, and coordinated arrival times are necessary to prevent severe travel burdens, particularly for lower-income households without private vehicles.

The second transitional support families discussed was social. Nearly one-third of respondents (32.1%) highlight student cohort preservation as a critical support. Parents emphasize that keeping grade-level cohorts, friend groups, and sibling sets together is essential for their students' social and emotional stability during building consolidations. Families also expressed concern that dividing established student bodies across multiple receiving sites could create social isolation and anxiety. Respondents asked the district to commit to intact cohort reassignments rather than splitting neighborhood cohorts across different attendance boundaries.

Similarly, over 17% of respondents focus on retaining familiar teachers, administrators, and support staff. Community members shared that familiar adults serve as stabilizing anchors for students undergoing building transitions. Parents ask the district to reassign teaching teams alongside student cohorts to receiving sites, ensuring that established relationships, school culture, and classroom routines continue in new facilities.

Finally, respondents called for structured transition protocols, mental health resources, and preserved childcare infrastructure. Families ask for spring orientation visits, joint field trips with receiving schools, and shadow days to help students adjust to new environments before fall. Parents also emphasize the need for guaranteed enrollment in SUN programs and fee-based aftercare, noting that losing local after-school care would make attending a reassigned school unmanageable for working parents.
Next, we further disaggregate the support requested by stakeholder groups and student services.

Students Receiving Special Education Services

Families of Special Education students emphasize that transition supports must focus on service continuity, IEP fidelity, and physical facility readiness. Parents of students with 504 plans or IEPs

expressed concerns that moving to larger receiving schools will disrupt established accommodations, sensory routines, and specialized behavioral supports. Respondents call for transition plans tailored to individual student needs, including site visits, dedicated quiet sensory spaces in school buildings, and physical accessibility retrofits like working elevators and secure perimeters.

Parents also highlight the necessity of retaining familiar support staff, such as paraprofessionals, speech-language pathologists, and special education teachers, who understand their children's specific learning profiles. A major focus among Southeast Portland families involves preserving specialized programs, such as the Deaf and Hard of Hearing (D/HH) program. Parents emphasize that keeping hearing and D/HH peers together alongside trained staff is essential to maintaining an inclusive learning environment.

Multilingual Learner Services (MLL)

Multilingual families emphasize the need for clear communication, direct outreach, and accessible transportation options. Parents report that navigating school changes requires district updates translated accurately into home languages, as well as in-person informational sessions rather than digital-only communication. Families also raise concerns about long commutes, noting that public transit transfers create significant barriers for working parents who lack their own transportation.

MLL families express concern over losing essential community wraps and non-academic support embedded in current neighborhood schools. Respondents point to services such as on-site food pantries, clothing centers, and family resource coordinators, such as those at Woodmere Elementary. Parents state that receiving schools must have equivalent community partner infrastructure and dedicated bilingual staff to ensure multilingual students maintain academic and social support.

Dual Language Immersion (DLI)

DLI families focus heavily on commute logistics, program access, and student safety. Parents note that relocating immersion programs across town forces families to choose between continuing dual-language education and managing long travel times. Respondents state that district-provided transportation is necessary for DLI families, particularly for those moving across regional corridors. Families also highlight safety concerns regarding federal immigration enforcement (ICE), asking for explicit district safety protocols and direct busing to protect families during daily travel.

DLI parents stress the importance of preserving heritage-language seats, keeping sibling groups in the same building, and maintaining program stability. Families express concern that consolidating DLI into single-site hubs will isolate immersion students from neighborhood peers or split multi-child households between general education and immersion campuses. Respondents ask the district to guarantee stable DLI pathways from elementary through high school without frequent boundary shifts.

Educators and Other Staff

Educators and school staff identified job security, clear contractual procedures, and adequate preparation time as their primary support needs. Staff expressed frustration over unclear reassignment rules, urging the district to provide transparent staffing models well ahead of implementation. Some families and staff emphasized that labor partner seniority rules during mergers must be managed carefully to protect newer teachers of color and bilingual educators, who provide critical mentorship to historically underserved students.

Staff also raised operational concerns regarding facility readiness and the logistics of moving schools. Educators point out that packing up classrooms, transferring specialized instructional materials, and setting up new teaching spaces requires dedicated paid contract days and professional moving services rather than uncompensated teacher labor. Furthermore, staff emphasize that receiving buildings must have functional technology, adequate room layouts, and enforced class size limits before welcoming merged student bodies.

Last Week in Community Engagement

This past week, PPS hosted an Educator Town Hall to learn more about how PAT staff would be affected by the proposed rightsizing scenarios. Follow this link to view the summaries of that engagement.

Please note: to see summaries of other community engagement sessions, view the What We Heard updates from previous weeks.

Appendix A: Count of Responses By School as of 11/2/26

***Note**: Some respondents represent multiple school communities*

School Name	# of Responses
Abernethy E.S.	56
ACCESS K-8	60
Ainsworth E.S.	25
Alameda E.S.	51
Alliance	15
Arleta E.S.	29
Astor K-8	35
Atkinson E.S.	70
Beach E.S.	78
Beaumont M.S.	66
Benson Polytechnic H.S.	51
Beverly Cleary K-8	95
Boise-Eliot/Humboldt E.S.	19
Brentwood M.S.	29
Bridger Creative Science School	50
Bridlemile E.S.	42
Buckman E.S.	49
Capitol Hill E.S.	27
Cesar Chavez K-8	42
Chapman E.S.	14
Chief Joseph E.S.	31
Clark E.S.	43
Cleveland H.S.	290
Creston E.S.	126
DaVinci Arts M.S.	47
Dr Martin Luther King Jr E.S.	46
Duniway E.S.	176
Faubion PK-8	39

Forest Park E.S.	23
Franklin H.S.	96
George M.S.	35
Glencoe E.S.	26
Grant H.S.	173
Grout E.S.	37
Harriet Tubman M.S.	68
Harrison Park M.S.	37
Hayhurst E.S.	33
Hosford M.S.	93
Ida B Wells-Barnett H.S.	116
Irvington E.S.	119
Jackson M.S.	123
James John E.S.	256
Jefferson H.S.	48
Kellogg M.S.	39
Kelly E.S.	12
Laurelhurst K-8	122
Lent E.S.	12
Leodis V McDaniel H.S.	50
Lewis E.S.	106
Lincoln H.S.	78
Llewellyn E.S.	164
Maplewood E.S.	177
Markham E.S.	38
Marysville E.S.	46
Metropolitan Learning Center	47
Mt Tabor M.S.	41
Ockley Green M.S.	66
Odyssey Program K-8	26
Peninsula E.S.	73
Pioneer	11

Reconnection Center	7
Richmond E.S.	34
Rieke E.S.	34
Rigler E.S.	34
Robert Gray M.S.	44
Roosevelt H.S.	66
Rosa Parks E.S.	15
Rose City Park E.S.	102
Roseway Heights M.S.	50
Sabin E.S.	120
Scott E.S.	74
Sellwood M.S.	422
Sitton E.S.	89
Skyline K-8	47
Stephenson E.S.	241
Sunnyside Environmental K-8	209
Sunrise E.S.	11
Vernon K-8	75
Vestal E.S.	21
West Sylvan M.S.	40
Whitman E.S.	26
Winterhaven K-8	31
Woodlawn E.S.	16
Woodmere E.S.	35
Woodstock E.S.	59
Grand Total	5994

Appendix B: Educator Town Hall Speak Back
October 29, 2026

Location: Cleveland High School at Marshall Campus
Number of Attendees: 61

What We Heard

A major focus of the Educator Town Hall was physical building limitations, classroom audits, and the costs of moving entire schools. Educators shared that capacity numbers do not reflect daily operational realities. For instance, teachers noted that receiving middle schools with a single gymnasium cannot handle doubled student populations during winter weather. Staff also pointed to the need for fenced outdoor play areas for Pre-K students, de-escalation spaces for special education, and the unbudgeted time required to pack and move classrooms. District administrators responded that operations teams are conducting site walks and "test fits" to ensure facility improvements happen before moves, but teachers remained skeptical that older receiving buildings can absorb higher student density.

Staff also raised concerns about closing specialized school models and losing the teacher-student relationships that keep students in school. Educators defended alternative programs like Sunnyside Environmental School (SES) and the Metropolitan Learning Center (MLC), noting that these programs serve large populations of neurodivergent and special education students who struggle in traditional settings. Student services staff and teachers warned that moving students from small, predictable environments into large middle and high schools removes the specific mentors and arts programs that prevent truancy and dropouts. Educators urged the district to identify and expand successful practices across the system rather than dismantling working models.

Educators and special education staff voiced frustration over the lack of explicit transition planning for high-needs students. Teachers noted that initial scenario proposals lacked details on Individualized Education Program (IEP) pullout spaces, physical accommodations, or staffing ratios. Staff also highlighted that centralizing Dual Language Immersion (DLI) programs increases commute distances and heightens exposure to federal immigration enforcement (ICE) for families.

Finally, educators expressed concern over the fast pace of the rightsizing timeline. Teachers and labor partners asked district leaders to advocate for state education funding rather than rushing a local rollout. Staff voiced distrust in the central office’s administrative capacity to execute a multi-school move, pointing to payroll errors, furloughs, and bumpy facility transitions like Cleveland High School's move to Marshall.